

- **Alias:** Commands built based on other commands for specific user purposes. The most important commands that you should know about are:
- **type** – Demonstrate how a command name is interpreted
- **which** – Display which executable program will be executed
- **help** – Get help for shell builtins
- **man** – Display a command's manual page
- **apropos** – Display a list of appropriate commands
- **info** – Results with a command's info entry
- **whatis** – Results with a very brief description of a command

type – to know a command's type

The **type** command is a shell builtin command which when used, results in the type of command from a specific command name. Syntax-

- `type command`

Here, a command must be the name of any particular command that one wants to understand. Here is a simple example to demonstrate this.

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ type type`
- `type is a shell builtin`
- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ type cp`
- `cp is /bin/cp`
- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ type ls`
- `ls is aliased to `ls --color=tty``

The first example for the **type** command is **type** itself, and the result displays it as a shell builtin. The second example for copying command **cp** gives its directory location at `/bin/cp`. While the third example for **ls** command it results as an alias for the command with `--color=tty` option explaining the use of colour.

which - to know the command location

More often there can be more than one version of a single executable program installed within a system. Here the '**which**' command is used to find the precise location of an executable program in a system.

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ which ls`
- `/bin/ls`

Note: which command will only work on executable programs. Neither for builtins nor for aliases as they represent the substitute for original executable programs only.

So when you use **which** command on any shell builtins results are either an error or no response. Here is quick demonstration for this:

- `[me@linuxbox ~]$ which cd`